European Commission

EUROPE'S BUDGET

Fisheries, aquaculture and the ocean

SEPTEMBER 2025

The new EU budget will ensure robust financial support for the sustainability and competitiveness of EU fishery and aquaculture, along with other blue economy sectors, while enhancing the resilience of coastal communities and ensuring a safe, secure and clean ocean.

Why is this a priority?

Europe must protect the ocean, ensure food security, boost a sustainable blue economy and support coastal communities by:

- ensuring the sustainability, competitiveness and resilience of European fisheries and aquaculture;
- enhancing the socio-economic opportunities of coastal communities and stimulating local growth;
- promoting the conservation of marine ecosystems in order to continue relying on them;
- supporting ocean observation, research and innovation, to promote marine knowledge and ocean literacy;
- ensuring strong ocean governance for a safe, secure, clean and sustainably managed ocean.

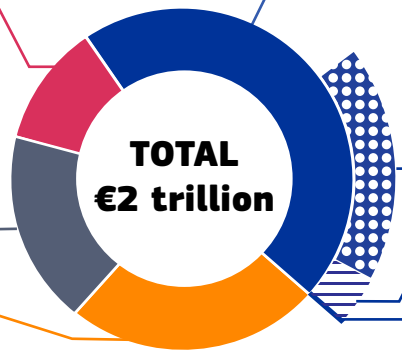
Together, the new funds **have the potential to go significantly beyond the amounts available from the previous 2021—2027 budget.**

What is the Commission proposing?

The new structure of the EU budget will give EU Member States more flexibility to tailor their budget to national, regional and local needs. It will result in better targeted and more impactful EU support where it matters most, and give faster and more flexible access to the sectors that need it the most.

The importance of the ocean, fisheries, aquaculture and maritime-related policies is recognised in the three major headings of the new EU budget.

2028—2034 EU BUDGET



Heading 3: €215 billion

Global Europe will help strengthen partnerships with non-EU countries and support ocean diplomacy and international ocean governance.

€341 billion

Other

Heading 2: €451 billion

The **European Competitiveness Fund** can foster investment in fisheries, aquaculture and maritime industries.

Horizon Europe will continue to support research and innovation.

Heading 1: €865 billion

The National and Regional Partnership (NRP) Fund including:

- **€453 billion** for economic, territorial and social cohesion, including for fisheries and coastal areas;
- **€72 billion** (as part of the NRP Fund) of which €11.5 billion can support fisheries, aquaculture, the maritime sector and ocean-based activities;
- **€2 billion** the minimum amount to implement some areas of the common fisheries policy.

Communication from the Commission to the European Parliament, the European Council, the Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions – A dynamic EU budget for the priorities of the future – The Multiannual Financial Framework 2028–2034 COM(2025) 570 final of 16 July 2025, accessed 17 September 2025, https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=COM:2025:570:FIN.

Promoting a healthy ocean

- Funding ocean observation, research and innovation, and marine knowledge to better understand and protect the marine environment.
- Support for EU ocean diplomacy to promote international cooperation and address global ocean challenges.
- Measures to prevent and combat illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing, protecting the livelihoods of fishers and the health of the ocean.

Supporting coastal communities

- Support for the development of sustainable blue economy initiatives, creating jobs, boosting small and medium enterprises and stimulating local economic growth.
- Funding for fisheries and aquaculture producers to invest in new technologies and practices, including blue carbon reserves and regenerative business opportunities, improving their competitiveness and resilience.
- Protection of the ocean's natural resources, ensuring the long-term viability of coastal communities and the industries that depend on them.

Promoting sustainable fisheries and aquaculture

- Funding data collection and fisheries control to ensure the long-term sustainability of fish stocks.
- Support for innovative and sustainable aquaculture and blue bioeconomy practices.
- Investment in start-ups and digital solutions to improve the sector's efficiency and environmental performance.

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